



## TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

# Gambia: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-25

Edition of 2026-08-25 • 75 systems and instruments tracked, 13 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-25 from the Data Landscapers source base. Sections follow the status report. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.

Of 75 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 31 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-25, 17 did not, 14 carry no stated baseline, and 13 are **Not held** at both ends.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 77 sources for this place in the window — 27 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-02), 50 in the later (2026-03 to 2026-08). The two halves are comparable, so the comparison is made over the whole window.

**Movement values.** *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

## Summary of the period

At the start of this period The Gambia had no data centre of any kind, produced identity cards under a foreign concession, had no comprehensive data-protection law and no instant payment rail. Twelve months later it has [two data centres](#), a [state-run identity system](#), an [enacted statute](#) and a [live payment switch](#) — four foundational pieces, all delivered inside one year.

What did not move is as consistent. Every register that was already running stayed exactly where it was: the civil registration figure and the social registry coverage figure are the same at both ends of the window, and no operating figure has been published for any of the four new systems. Two announced arrangements produced nothing at all — the [blockchain platform of January 2025](#) and the [transport fare partnership of June 2025](#) — and the [Starlink licence is refused at the end of the period as it was withheld at the start](#).

## Infrastructure

### Connectivity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                        | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT |
|---------------------------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| GAMTEL national broadband modernisation PPP | Did not exist | US\$50m partnership signed to take the national backbone from 40 Gbps to 800 Gbps; no completion date, milestone schedule or dalasi figure published (2026-01) | ADVANCED |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                           | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                      | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Gambia National Broadband Network (China Eximbank loan)</b> | In service under a US\$25.9m concessional loan repayable by GAMTEL, with a servicing history of arrears (2017 loan)                | Unchanged on the record; no statement of network condition, utilisation or debt position since 2020                                                              | NO CHANGE |
| <b>Liberia-Gambia-Sierra Leone roaming agreement</b>           | Signed; no tariff, traffic or commencement figure published (2025-08)                                                              | Unchanged; no tariff, traffic or commencement figure published (2026-08)                                                                                         | NO CHANGE |
| <b>Starlink satellite service licence</b>                      | Fee paid and licence unissued for over a year, the government citing due diligence in the face of United States pressure (2025-07) | Still unlicensed; the minister states Starlink lacks the competencies and equipment for a VSAT permit and requires a general satellite licence instead (2026-05) | NO CHANGE |

## Data Storage

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT               | AT 2025-08-01                                       | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT |
|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>National Data Centre, Abuko</b> | Did not exist                                       | State facility in service hosting the national identity management system; no capacity, tier rating or operating cost published (2026-07) | ADVANCED |
| <b>QGroup House data centre</b>    | Did not exist; no data centre of any kind on record | First private data centre in service, built by QGroup and QCell with Huawei as long-term vendor (2026-04)                                 | ADVANCED |

## Energy

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                  | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                                                            | MOVEMENT          |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Grid generation capacity added</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | 23 MWp of solar with 8 MWh of battery storage, one of two parks totalling 48 MWp built under a combined US\$149m investment providing new or improved electricity to 500,000 people across two countries | Baseline not held |

## Cybersecurity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                           | AT 2025-08-01                               | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>National cybersecurity agency or incident response team</b> | No position held at the start of the window | An institutional design on paper: GM-CSIRT operating a national Cybersecurity Centre with a security operations centre inside it, a National Cybersecurity Coordination Directorate, a National Cybersecurity Commission, an advisory board, sectoral focal points and sector CSIRTs, and a police cybercrime response unit. The plan directs that GM-CSIRT be operationalised and strengthened in budget and technology; nothing held states that any of these bodies is standing | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

Hosting went from nothing to two facilities. [QGroup House opened on 30 April 2026](#) and the [state's National Data Centre on 1 July 2026](#). That is the single largest change in the country's digital estate in the period, and neither facility has published a capacity figure, a tier rating or an operating cost.

The backbone acquired a contract rather than capacity. The [US\\$50m partnership announced on 5 January 2026](#) commits to raising national capacity from 40 Gbps to 800 Gbps, and no milestone under it has been reported since. The earlier network built on Chinese concessional lending has produced no statement of condition or debt position at either end of the window.

Satellite access is where the period's clearest non-movement sits. At the start the licence had been paid for and not issued; at the end the [minister has stated the ground for refusing it](#) – the wrong licence category – which is a more explicit position, not a different one.

## Digital public infrastructure

### Data Exchange

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                         | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Gambia-Senegal customs data exchange roadmap | Did not exist | Agreed to install the GAINDE customs system at Karang, Keur Ayib and Selety within three months, deploy SIGMAT transit tracking, exchange customs data by interface once GAINDE is live, replace transit agents with a Single Administrative Document and reactivate the EnCen intelligence platform (2026-07) | ADVANCED |
| National Enterprise Architecture             | Did not exist | Validated as the interoperability blueprint for citizen-centric services; not adopted, funded or implemented on the record (2026-05)                                                                                                                                                                           | ADVANCED |

### Digital Identity and CRVS

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                         | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT |
|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Margins ID national identity contract        | Did not exist; the standing arrangement was the concession the 2025 State of the Nation address set out to replace (2025-08) | Eight-year design-build-finance-operate-transfer contract in force, with a 70/30 revenue share, ten-year card validity, free replacement of valid cards and a phase-2 data centre (2026-01)                           | ADVANCED |
| National Identity Management System (GAM ID) | Did not exist; identity cards were produced under a foreign concession the government had resolved to replace (2025-08)      | Live and issuing instant cards from the National Data Centre, with nationwide rollout of new ten-year biometric national identity cards launched on 7 August 2026 and registration open simultaneously at six centres | ADVANCED |

### Digital Payments and Fintech

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                             | AT 2025-08-01                                                                 | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | MOVEMENT  |
|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| BANTABA 2.0 instant payment system               | Did not exist                                                                 | First inclusive instant payment system in service, built on Mojaloop and operated by GamSwitch across banks, mobile money, microfinance institutions and fintechs; no transaction volume published (2025-12)                                           | ADVANCED  |
| SUTURA government revenue collection integration | Did not exist                                                                 | Memorandum signed to wire a domestically built platform, distributed through GAMPOST, into government revenue collection; no go-live date, volume, fee structure or list of connected banks published, and no text of the memorandum is held (2026-07) | ADVANCED  |
| Yonna Wallet government payment collection       | Did not exist                                                                 | Collecting identity card, passport and business-registration fees, with diaspora payment through the Yonna Global Wallet and auto-generated receipts; no volume or fee structure published (2026-03)                                                   | ADVANCED  |
| Wave-GTSC public transport fare payment          | Partnership signed; no deployment, route or volume figure published (2025-08) | Unchanged; no deployment, route or volume figure published (2026-08)                                                                                                                                                                                   | NO CHANGE |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                         | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | MOVEMENT                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| UNDP-FreedomPay Wallet blockchain payment distribution pilot | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | UNDP working with FreedomPay Wallet in The Gambia on transparent digital payment distribution, grouped with pilots in Haiti, Syria, Kenya and Guatemala; no country-specific volume, beneficiary count or launch date for The Gambia is published | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                            | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                     | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Electronic civil registration and vital statistics              | In service as the interoperability backbone, about 1.17m people registered with a unique national identification number (2024-03) | Unchanged; the June 2025 commitment to integrate it with identity cards and the passport has produced no published integration milestone (2026-08)                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>NO CHANGE</b>         |
| Gambia Social Registry                                          | 203,022 households, about 70% of the population, carrying the Nafa cash transfers (2024-04)                                       | Unchanged; no coverage update published since (2026-08)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>NO CHANGE</b>         |
| National Land Administration System and Land Information System | Not held                                                                                                                          | Mandated by the country's first unified National Land Policy 2026-2035, which requires a digitalised National Land Administration System, a centralised Land Information System and digitised land registration alongside new Certificates of Customary Ownership, backed by a costed ten-year implementation roadmap | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |
| Supplementary voter registration records                        | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                                                          | 212,095 registrations announced against 179,445 records on the data distributed to parties, a gap the commission attributes to unverified processing outputs (2026-08)                                                                                                                                                | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                             | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT                 |
|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| DHIS2 for Education                              | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Individual learner tracking and school report cards being built on DHIS2 by the basic and secondary education ministry; no coverage figure or go-live date published (2026-05) | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| Smart Paper Technology for community health data | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | In use for community health data capture; no district count or record volume published (2025-12)                                                                               | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Other GovTech and e-Gov

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                | AT 2025-08-01                                                                 | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT         |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Civil servant and pensioner verification exercise   | A verification exercise scheduled to run up-country from 17 to 23 August 2026 | The provincial round suspended until further notice over unspecified technical difficulties, with the Greater Banjul Area exercise confirmed to start on 20 August 2026 | <b>REGRESSED</b> |
| Digital Single Window Business Registration System  | Did not exist                                                                 | Being finalised, with over 350 agricultural enterprises digitally mapped inside a programme reaching more than 4,050 firms; no launch date published (2026-08)          | <b>ADVANCED</b>  |
| Digitalisation of police records                    | Did not exist                                                                 | Directed by the Inspector General; no system, vendor, budget or timetable published (2026-03)                                                                           | <b>ADVANCED</b>  |
| Election digitalisation for the December 2026 polls | Did not exist                                                                 | Polling-station mapping, results transmission and tablets announced for the December 2026 elections; no procurement, test or audit arrangement published (2026-03)      | <b>ADVANCED</b>  |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                           | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                                                           | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Integrated Tax Administration System</b>                    | Did not exist                                                                                                                                                                           | Planned for electronic filing; no procurement, vendor, timetable or budget line published (2026-07)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>National Digital Addressing rollout</b>                     | No standing body; the Digital Addressing Policy dates from 2023 (2025-08)                                                                                                               | Steering committee launched; no national coverage figure or rollout milestone published (2025-10)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>Digital excise tax stamp</b>                                | In operation, implemented by SICPA Gambia; the authority's own figures put excise collections at D48.47m for January to August 2024 against D6.31m in the same months of 2023 (2025-08) | In operation and studied by revenue administrations from Nigeria, Senegal, Sierra Leone, South Africa and Rwanda; the authority claims a 95% reduction in smuggling of excisable goods, with no method and no independent verification (2026-07)                                                                                                                                                                                            | NO CHANGE                |
| <b>GRA digital tax invoicing</b>                               | In service with tamper-proof digital signatures; no coverage or yield figure published (2025-08)                                                                                        | Named in the finance ministry's account of the reform stack; still no separate coverage or yield figure (2026-07)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | NO CHANGE                |
| <b>Integrated Financial Management Information System</b>      | In service across ministries with revenue and treasury interfaces (2020)                                                                                                                | Unchanged; no statement of coverage or condition since the project closed (2026-08)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | NO CHANGE                |
| <b>Community policing case management and facility mapping</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                                                                                                                | Mobile case-management applications and geographic facility mapping in use under a United Nations Development Programme-backed community policing programme; no case volume published (2026-03)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Baseline not held        |
| <b>Objections to the supplementary voter roll</b>              | Not held                                                                                                                                                                                | 1,600 objections filed against the 2026 supplementary voter roll on eligibility and residency, being heard by revising court magistrates before the provisional register merges with the 2021 register; the commission's chairman states the register will be credible once the revising court finishes, that the names removed were multiple registrations covered by an earlier amnesty, and that no eligible registrant has been omitted | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

## Digitalisation of sub-national government

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                         | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT          |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Kanifing municipal digital addressing</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | 36,000 properties georeferenced, feeding property-tax billing and waste management in Kanifing Municipality (2025-12) | Baseline not held |

## National statistics

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                  | AT 2025-08-01                                                          | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | MOVEMENT |
|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Coordination of official statistics production</b> | No convened process on record                                          | Producers and users convened by the Central Bank with the International Monetary Fund and the Bureau of Statistics, naming data gaps, inconsistency and inaccessibility as the constraints; no framework or workplan published (2026-07) | ADVANCED |
| <b>Gambia Labour Force Survey series</b>              | Four rounds published, with no cross-round comparison volume (2025-08) | Fifth round published with the first systematic comparison across the 2023, 2025 and 2026 rounds, and a sixth round confirmed for later in 2026 (2026-07)                                                                                | ADVANCED |
| <b>Labour force participation rate</b>                | 43.6% (2023 Q1)                                                        | 54.5% (2026 Q1)                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ADVANCED |
| <b>Unemployment rate</b>                              | 7.6% (2023 Q1)                                                         | 6.2% (2026 Q1)                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | ADVANCED |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                   | AT 2025-08-01                                                  | AT 2026-08-25   | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Agriculture share of employment</b> | Not comparable; earlier rounds counted own-use food production | 17.8% (2026 Q1) | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

Identity moved twice in twelve months: from a concession to a [signed contract in January 2026](#), and from a contract to a [live system on 1 July 2026](#). Both ends of the underlying register, however, are the same figure: the civil registration system stands at about 1.17m people at the start and the end of the period, and the [social registry at 203,022 households](#) at both. The registers on which the new system depends have published nothing since 2024.

Payments gained three channels and no numbers. The [switch went live in December 2025](#), [Yonna Wallet in March 2026](#) and [SUTURA by memorandum in July 2026](#). None has published a transaction volume, and the [2025 transport fare partnership](#) has produced no deployment at all.

Revenue systems held their position while the claims about them grew. The digital excise stamp is in operation at both ends; what changed is the [set of administrations coming to study it](#) and the addition of a 95% smuggling-reduction claim carrying no method. That is a change in the system's reputation, not in its measured performance, and the two are worth keeping apart.

Statistics show the clearest measured movement in the ledger. Labour force participation moved from [43.6% in the 2023 round to 54.5% in 2026](#) and unemployment from 7.6% to 6.2%, and the [comparison volume that establishes both is itself new](#). The agriculture share cannot be compared across the window at all: the producer changed the standard.

## Governance and regulation

### Legislation and regulation

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                     | AT 2025-08-01                                                        | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT        |
|----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Broadcasting and Online Content Regulations, 2026</b> | Did not exist                                                        | A draft instrument made by the minister in charge of broadcasting content under section 226(1) of the Information and Communications Act (Cap. 74:03) in consultation with the regulator, issued for public consultation on 2 April 2026 as one of seven draft instruments released together — among them Journalists Registration Guidelines, 2026 and licensing, registration and authorisation guidelines. Its fourteen parts run from objectives and general obligations through a content complaints committee, licensing and professional standards, classification tiers, content monitoring, local-content promotion, coverage of public events, public service broadcasting, watershed and children's programming, complaints handling, and enforcement and sanctions; the child-protection provisions the information minister set out cover the identity of child victims, parental or guardian consent for interviews with children, and content that harms or exploits minors | <b>ADVANCED</b> |
| <b>Communications Bill 2025</b>                          | Not introduced; first reading followed on 19 November 2025 (2025-08) | Passed second reading and referred to committee, with the Press Union pressing for repeal of the restrictive media laws around it (2026-07)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | <b>ADVANCED</b> |
| <b>State Intelligence Service Bill</b>                   | Did not exist                                                        | Draft validated, reported to require judicial warrants and oversight for intrusive measures and to give the Assembly review of the Service's budgets and operations; not tabled (2026-07)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | <b>ADVANCED</b> |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT      | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                     | MOVEMENT                 |
|---------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Access to Information Act | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | In force, but with most public institutions yet to appoint the information officers the Act requires and twenty-one-day requests going unanswered | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Strategies, plans and policies

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                      | AT 2025-08-01                                                              | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| National Cybersecurity Strategy and Action Plan 2022-2026 | In force, on a period running to 2026 (2025-08)                            | Unchanged; no successor, mid-term review or implementation report is held, and the plan runs out at the end of 2026 (2026-08) | <b>NO CHANGE</b> |
| National Data Policy 2025                                 | Draft, not adopted (2025-08)                                               | Still a draft; no adoption, gazetting or implementation instrument is held (2026-08)                                          | <b>NO CHANGE</b> |
| National Digital Economy Master Plan 2024-2034            | In force as the framing instrument for the digital programme (2025-08)     | Unchanged; no mid-term review, monitoring report or costed implementation plan is held (2026-08)                              | <b>NO CHANGE</b> |
| National Digital Identity Strategy 2023-2028              | In force, with the identity system it provides for not yet built (2025-08) | In force and now carrying a delivered identity system (2026-07)                                                               | <b>NO CHANGE</b> |

## Regional collaboration

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                             | AT 2025-08-01                         | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT        |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| ATAF Heads of Tax Administrations Master Class                   | Did not exist as a Gambian commitment | Convened by the Gambia Revenue Authority, with the Forum's executive secretary arguing that digital systems deliver only alongside governance reform and pressing for a united African position in the United Nations tax convention negotiations (2026-07) | <b>ADVANCED</b> |
| Senegal-Gambia regulatory cooperation and free roaming agreement | Did not exist                         | Signed, covering telecommunications regulatory cooperation and free roaming; no commencement date or tariff published (2026-06)                                                                                                                             | <b>ADVANCED</b> |

## Data protection

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                          | AT 2025-08-01                                                                             | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT                 |
|-----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Personal Data Protection and Privacy Act 2025 | No comprehensive data-protection law; the Bill was before the National Assembly (2025-08) | Enacted, with extraterritorial scope, seven lawful bases, a sensitive-data regime covering genetic, biometric and health data, and rights of access, rectification, erasure and protection from solely automated decisions (2025-12)                                                                        | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| Information Commission                        | Not held                                                                                  | Operating as the body responsible for the Access to Information Act 2021 and the Personal Data Protection and Privacy Act 2025, and receiving UNFPA-funded support under the Peacebuilding Fund's Public Accountability Project to build a communication strategy raising public awareness of both statutes | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

The statute book moved and the policy shelf did not. The Gambia had no comprehensive data-protection law when this period opened; the [Personal Data Protection and Privacy Act](#) was enacted by December 2025, ending a process that had stalled for several years. The [Communications Bill](#) went from not introduced to sitting with committees after a second reading in March 2026, and a [State Intelligence Service Bill](#) that did not exist at the start of the window was validated on 31 July 2026.



Against that, the [National Data Policy 2025](#) is a draft at both ends and the [Master Plan 2024-2034](#) has produced no [review or costed plan](#) in twelve months. The one instrument whose position improved without moving is the identity strategy: unchanged as a document, but [now carrying a delivered system rather than an intention](#).

The regional layer is new. The [agreement with Senegal on regulatory cooperation and free roaming](#) did not exist a year ago, and neither did the country's [hosting of the continent's tax administrators](#).

## Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

### ICT Industry

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                   | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                          | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT            |
|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| <b>GAMCEL 80% share sale and network modernisation</b> | Sale of 80% of GAMCEL announced to lawmakers at a winning bid of D6.7bn, no agreement signed (2025-12) | <a href="#">Agreement signed transferring an 80% equity stake to YCELL against a GMD 6.1bn modernisation programme covering 4G and 5G radio access, core, operations and billing systems, hybrid tower power and revenue assurance (2026-07)</a> | <div>ADVANCED</div> |

### Innovation ecosystem

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                  | AT 2025-08-01                                              | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Kalp Foundation Gambia One blockchain platform</b> | Memorandum signed; nothing on record being built (2025-08) | <a href="#">Unchanged; no build, pilot, funding or withdrawal reported in the nineteen months since (2026-08)</a>                                          | <div>NO CHANGE</div>     |
| <b>Gambia Digital Innovation Sprint</b>               | <div>BASELINE NOT HELD</div>                               | <a href="#">Held with the National Youth Council, the communications ministry and UNICEF; no follow-on funding or incubation route published (2026-07)</a> | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

The state's exit from mobile ownership is the sector's one movement. At the start of the period the sale of GAMCEL had been [announced to lawmakers at a D6.7 billion winning bid with no agreement signed](#); at the end an [80% stake has transferred against a GMD 6.1 billion modernisation commitment](#). No post-transaction financial position for either operator has been published.

Set against it, the [blockchain platform agreed in January 2025](#) is at the same position at both ends of the window: a memorandum, with no build, pilot, funding or withdrawal reported in nineteen months.

On artificial intelligence there is nothing to compare. The base carried no Gambian position at the start of the period and carries none now.

## Inclusion and capacity

### Literacy

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                  | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT            |
|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| <b>Rural women and girls digital rights programme</b> | Did not exist | <a href="#">400 women and girls trained across four regions, with 40 community broadcasters and 80 peer mentors; the implementer names unreliable internet, high data costs and unreliable electricity as the obstacles to continued practice (2026-07)</a> | <div>ADVANCED</div> |



## Training and skills

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                    | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT |
|-----------------------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| National Labour Digital Skill programme | Did not exist | Methodology validated against a target of 280 certified, funded at US\$3.35m through the regional digital integration programme; no completion figure published (2025-12) | ADVANCED |

Two programmes arrived where nothing existed: a [digital skills methodology validated in December 2025](#) against a target of 280 certified, and a [rural digital rights programme that reached 400 women and girls](#) across four regions.

## Finance

### New investments

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                  | AT 2025-08-01                                                            | AT 2026-08-25                                                                      | MOVEMENT  |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| AfDB digital government project       | Pipeline (2025-08)                                                       | Still pipeline; no approval, signature or first disbursement is held (2026-08)     | NO CHANGE |
| Gates Foundation payment system pilot | Closed (2025-08)                                                         | Closed; no evaluation or successor operation is held (2026-08)                     | NO CHANGE |
| WARDIP national allocation            | In implementation; no disbursement or results figure published (2025-08) | Unchanged; no disbursement, results framework or mid-term review is held (2026-08) | NO CHANGE |

### Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-25                                   | MOVEMENT |
|----------------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Tax-to-GDP ratio     | 9% (2022)     | 13% (2025)                                      | ADVANCED |
| Total tax collected  | D11bn (2022)  | D25bn (2025), against a D27.5bn target for 2026 | ADVANCED |

The clearest movement in the state's own account of the period is fiscal. Total tax collected went from [D11bn in 2022 to D25bn in 2025](#) and the [ratio of tax to GDP from 9% to 13%](#); both series were published within this window rather than accruing across it, and both are the collecting side's own account of its performance.

External financing did not move at all. The [World Bank's regional programme allocation](#) has published no disbursement or results figure at either end of the period, the [African Development Bank's digital government project is pipeline at both ends](#), and the [Gates Foundation's payment pilot was closed before the window opened](#) and has produced no evaluation since.

## Where the record is thin

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                | WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT                                                                                                                                                                    | LAST PROBED    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Power supply to the national digital estate                         | A generation, tariff or outage statement bearing on data-centre or network operation, or the power provision in either data centre's design.                                            | not yet probed |
| Domestic technical capacity to operate the national digital systems | A staffing plan, skills audit or operations report covering who runs the National Data Centre, the identity system and the payment switch.                                              | not yet probed |
| Rural digital data capture                                          | An agricultural, land or extension data-collection programme, or a rural administration digital plan. The health and social registry systems are the only field data capture on record. | not yet probed |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                              | WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT                                                                                                                                                                           | LAST PROBED    |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <b>Data Protection and Privacy Commission</b>                     | A commencement instrument, an appointment notice, a budget line or a first annual report. The Act provides for an independent Commission; nothing held states whether it has been constituted. | 2026-08-09     |
| <b>Legal basis for issuing identity cards outside the country</b> | An official response, a regulation or a registry statement covering issuance in Mauritania, Congo and Togo, which the opposition alleged was unlawful in August 2025.                          | not yet probed |
| <b>National open-data portal</b>                                  | A published portal, dataset catalogue, or the text of the Open Data Strategy 2023-2026 the base refers to but does not hold.                                                                   | not yet probed |
| <b>Public participation in digital policymaking</b>               | A consultation register, a published submission round, or a civil-society account of participation in the data, communications or intelligence bills.                                          | not yet probed |
| <b>European Union digital cooperation with The Gambia</b>         | A Global Gateway announcement, an EU delegation programme document, or a financing agreement naming The Gambia.                                                                                | not yet probed |
| <b>National artificial intelligence policy or strategy</b>        | A policy, strategy, readiness assessment or ministerial statement on artificial intelligence. The only material bearing on The Gambia in the base is a continental data-protection roundup.    | not yet probed |
| <b>Indian digital cooperation with The Gambia</b>                 | A bilateral memorandum, a line of credit, or an India Stack or technical cooperation programme document naming The Gambia.                                                                     | not yet probed |
| <b>Gulf state digital investment in The Gambia</b>                | An investment agreement, data-centre or connectivity commitment from a Gulf sovereign fund or operator.                                                                                        | not yet probed |
| <b>Domestic budget appropriations for the digital sector</b>      | An appropriation act, budget speech or estimate showing the votes for the communications ministry, the regulator and the digital programme.                                                    | not yet probed |
| <b>Affordability of internet access</b>                           | A domestic price basket, an affordability survey, or a regulator tariff series. Penetration is held only from a commercial reference compilation.                                              | not yet probed |

These rows carry no reliable position at either end of the period, so no movement can be stated for them. They are not evenly distributed: the largest concentration is around the two new data centres, where the base holds nothing on power, nothing on the technical capacity that runs them and nothing on any body responsible for their security.

The second concentration is fiscal. A year in which the state's central claim for digitalisation is a revenue claim is also a year in which no appropriation line for the digital programme appears anywhere in the base, and no domestic measure of what access costs a household has been published at either end.

---

## ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| EDITION         | <b>2026-08-25</b>                                                                                                                                                   |
| CURRENT EDITION | <a href="https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/GMB/GMB-progress.html">https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/GMB/GMB-progress.html</a>                     |
| THIS FILE       | <a href="https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/GMB/GMB-progress-2026-08-25.pdf">https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/GMB/GMB-progress-2026-08-25.pdf</a> |
| LICENCE         | <a href="#">CC BY 4.0</a>                                                                                                                                           |

Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.